# UNIT 6: AFFORESTATION

## Unit Objectives

**At the end of this unit, you will be able to:**

- Listen to a text about advantages of afforestation;
- Express their agreement and disagreement about plants;
- Appreciate a poem about trees;
- Recognize meanings of words from a text.
- Use prefixes and suffixes;
- Use relative clauses appropriately;
- Write a summary of a text.

## SECTION ONE

## Lesson 1

### Pre-Listening

**Activity 6.1:**

1. What differences do you see between Picture A and Picture B? Discuss in groups.
2. What is the reason for the differences?

**Picture A**

**Picture B**

**Activity 6.2: Do the following questions, and compare your answers with your partner's.**

1. How do you differentiate reforestation from afforestation?
2. Why do people plant trees?
3. Can you think of some advantages of afforestation?

### While-Listening

**Activity 6.3: Your teacher will talk about the advantages of afforestation. Listen to the talk, and answer the questions below. See the questions below before you listen to the talk.**

1. What is afforestation?
2. How does afforestation differ from reforestation?
3. Write down the three advantages of afforestation.
4. What happens to the amount of carbon dioxide when people cut down trees?
5. What did Ethiopia do in 2019?
6. What does ecosystem mean?

## Lesson 2

### Post-Listening

**Activity 6.4: Why do you think people plant trees? Ask information about this from your parents or anyone in your area. Then, write down the reasons. Use complete sentences to report to the whole class.**

# SECTION TWO: Speaking

## Lesson 3

### Agreeing and Disagreeing

**Activity 6.5: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following idea?**

***The wealth of any country is its plants.***

► Write notes. Give reasons for either agreeing or disagreeing with the statement. Tell your classmates about your reasons for agreeing and disagreeing.

Some phrases for expressing agreement or disagreement are the following:

- I agree with the idea …
- I do not agree with the idea…
- That is partly true, but …
- agree because I think that ... (explain your reason)

For more on expressions

Use the following table to list down your reasons.

| Reasons for agreeing | Reasons for disagreeing |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

# SECTION THREE: Reading

## Lesson 4

### Pre-Reading

**Activity 6.6: See the picture of a tree below. Discuss the use of trees.**

**Activity 6.7: Answer the following questions. Compare your answers with your partne's.**

1. Can people and animals live without trees? Give your reasons.
2. Do you know the meanings of the following words?
   - Afforestation
   - Reforestation

## While-Reading

**Activity 6.8: Read the following poem about plants.**

### Trees

Trees are the kindest things I know,
They do, they simply grow
And spread a shade for sleepy cows,
And gather birds in their branches.

They give us fruit in leaves above,
And wood to make our houses of,

And leaves made for medicine
And in the Spring new buds of green.
They are first when day's begun
To hold the beams of morning sun,
They are the last to hold the light
When evening changes into night.

And when a moon floats on the sky
They hum a drowsy lullaby
Of sleepy children long ago...
Trees are the kindest things I know.

But we are cutting down trees,
Neither making afforestation plans,
To create new forests,
Nor making a reforestation of depleted lands,
To replace the lost ones.
We all should take care,
Of our mother nature.

- Slightly adapted from Harry Behn

# Lesson 5

## While-reading

**Activity 6.9: Based on the poem, answer the following questions. Discuss your answers in your group.**

1. Write down five facts which prove evidence of the kindness of trees towards others. Com pare your list with your partner's.
2. Identify from the poem lines that create a picture in your mind.
3. Why are trees called harmless? Explain with examples.
4. In 'But we are cutting down trees', who does the word 'we' refer to?
5. In the last line of the poem, the author wrote 'mother nature'. Why is this expression used?

**Activity 6.10: Are the following statements true or false? Give reasons.**

1) Trees are unkind to human being.
2) Trees offer shelter to birds.
3) Birds sing a lullaby.
4) Trees are kind because the sun is kind to them.
5) Trees go to sleep before the sun set.
6) Trees are first to welcome the sun.

# Lesson 6

## Post-reading

**Activity 6.11: Discuss the following questions in your group.**

1. How do you see the relationship between planting trees and climate change?
2. What other things should people do to reduce global warming? Should this worry you? Why?/ Why not?
3. If people stopped planting trees, what would happen?
4. Write a short poem about trees.

# Lesson 7

## Vocabulary

**Activity 6.12: Discuss the following questions in your group.**

**1. Based on the poem you have read, match the words on the left with the definitions on the right.**

| A | B |
|---|---|
| 1. afforestation | a. Planting trees in an area where there used to be a forest |
| 2. deplete | b. Planting trees to form a new forest |
| 3. spring | c. Damage or injury |
| 4. beam | d. To consume a limited resource |
| 5. harm | e. The season between winter and summer when plants begin to grow |
| 6. kind | f. A line of light |
| 7. reforestation | g. Caring about others |

**2. Write meaningful sentences of your own using each of the words under column A.**

**Activity 6.13: Read the poem presented again. Find words that describe the following. Then, write the meanings of the phrases.**

e.g. depleted lands (The word 'depleted' describes 'lands').

i) _____ cows

ii) _____ things

iii) _____ buds

iv) _____ sun

v) _____ lullaby

vi) _____ children

**3. Write sentences using the expressions, and compare it with your partner's.**

# Lesson 8

## Affixes: Prefixes and Suffixes

### Brainstorming: Study how the following words are formed.

- afforestation (a-forest-ation) [originally from add-forest]
- deforestation (de-forest-ation)

a. The two words differ in meaning. Why do they have different meanings?

b. What is the meaning of the prefix **de-** in 'deforestation'?

| |
|---|
| *Prefixes are a letter or a group of letters that are added before a word to change its meaning.*<br>*Example: misuse*<br>*'mis-' means 'wrongly'.* |
| *Suffixes are word endings to change the word classes.*<br>*Example: selfish*<br>*'-ish' means 'like'.* |

## Prefixes: changing meanings

**o With adjectives**

**Prefixes, e.g. *un-, dis-, im-, can* be added to some adjectives to give the opposite meaning.**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| happy (feeling or showing pleasure) | unhappy | | honest (tells the truth) | dishonest |
| possible (that can be done) | impossible | | correct (right) | Incorrect |
| regular (following pattern) | irregular | | legal (allowed by law) | illegal |

o **With verbs**

**With some verbs, these prefixes can have particular meanings.**

| | |
|---|---|
| ***dis***- [the opposite of something] | I **disagree** with the others. [don't agree/ have the same opinion] |
| ***un***- [the opposite of an action] | I couldn't **unlock** the door this morning. [open the door using a key, opposite= lock] |
| ***over***- [too much] | The bank **overcharged** me. [asked me to pay too much money] |
| ***mis***- [do something incorrectly] | I **misunderstood** what the teacher said. I am sorry, my English is not very good. |
| ***re***- [again] | The teacher has asked me to **rewrite** my essay. |

o **With Nouns**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ***co-*** | joint | co-founder, co-owner, co-descendant |
| ***dis-*** | the converse of | discomfort, dislike |
| ***sub-*** | below | subset, subdivision |
| ***tele-*** | distant | telecommunications, |

**Activity 6.14: Read the poem presented again. Find words that describe the following. Then, write the meanings of the phrases.**

a. Can you name some more?

b. Make a sentence using some of the words.

# Lesson 9

**Activity 6.15: In each of the following dialogues, B agrees with A using different words. Complete the blank spaces from the list of words given in the box below.**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| dishonest | illegal | undressed |
| incorrect | unlucky | unlikely |
| unexpected | unfair | unfit |

1. A: That is a strange name.
   B: Yes, it's very ***unusual***.
2. A: It's against the law, isn't it?
   B: Oh yes, it's _____.
3. A: You mean he took off all his clothes!
   B: Yes, he got completely _____.
4. A: He probably won't get back in time for the meeting.
   B: I agree. It's very _____.
5. A: A lot of the answers were wrong _____.
   B: Yes, I'm afraid they were nearly all _____.
6. A: He doesn't look in very good condition; he's a bit overweight.
   B: I know. He looks terribly _____.
7. A: Nobody thought this would happen.
   B: Yes, it was completely _____.
8. A: They never tell the truth.
   B: I know. They're both _____.
9. A: His business always seems to lose money, and it's not his fault.
   B: I know. He's very _____.
10. A: Semira always gives more attention to Kibru than she does to Befekadu.
    B: Yes, it's very _____ on poor Befekadu.

# Lesson 10

## Suffixes

### Verb + noun suffix

Suffixes are used at the end of words; they often tell you if a word is a noun, a verb, an adjective or an adverb. Two suffixes which form nouns from verbs are -ion and -ment.

| Verb | Noun |
|---|---|
| invent [produce or design something completely new] | invention |
| discuss [talk about something seriously] | discussion |
| translate [change from one language to another] | translation |
| relax [rest, and feel calm and comfortable] | relaxation |
| improve [get better] govern [control the affairs of a city or country] | improvement |
| manage [direct or control a business] | management |
| develop [grow or change and become more advanced] | development |

Examples:

- His latest invention is a new board game.
- The management has to change.
- We need an improvement in the weather.

**Activity 6.16: Make sentences using discussion, translation, relaxation, and development.**

- **Adjective + noun suffix**
- **The suffixes *-ness* and *-ity* often form nouns from adjectives.**

| **weak (opposite: strong)** | **weakness** |
|---|---|
| happy | happiness |
| ill [sick, not well] | illness |
| fit [in good condition, usually because of exercise] | fitness |
| stupid (opposite intelligent, clever) | stupidity |
| popular [liked by a lot of people] | popularity |
| similar [almost the same; opposite: different] | similarity |
| Able | ability |

Examples

- What is his main weakness as a teacher?
- Fortunately, it wasn't a serious illness.

# Lesson 11

**Activity 6.17: Write down meaningful sentences using happiness, fitness, stupidity, popularity, similarity, and ability.**

- ***-er, -or* and *-ist***
- **These suffixes can be added to nouns or verbs. They often describe people and jobs.**

| **-er** | **-or** | **-ist** |
|---|---|---|
| foreigner | director | scientist |
| footballer | actor | artist |
| pop singer | translator | economist |

**Activity 6.18: Write down the names of the people who do these things as a job.**

- Example: sing music **singers**

1. act in films _____
2. important managers in a company _____
3. change words from one language into another _____
4. play football _____
5. dance in ballets _____
6. paint pictures _____
7. work in science _____

**Activity 6.19: Complete the dialogues.**

Example: A: He hasn't been well at all, has he?

B: No, it's quite a serious **illness** .

1. A: Are they almost the same?
   B: Yes, the _____ is amazing.
2. A: Has anyone made anything like this before?
   B: No, it's a brand-new_____ .
3. A: Is her new novel going to be published in other languages?
   B: Yes, someone is working on a _____ right now.
4. A: Does your daughter enjoy drawing too?
   B: Yes, she's a very good _____ .
5. A: Javier gets tired after he's been playing for about ten minutes.
   B: I know. If he wants to be in the team, he'll have to improve his_____ .
6. A: Do you think the organization can still grow?
   B: Yes, I think there is an opportunity for further _____

# Lesson 12

## Suffixes: forming adjectives

Common suffixes that form adjectives include: ***-able*** (comfortable), ***-al*** (musical), ***-y*** (cloudy), ***-ous*** (famous) and ***-ive*** (attractive).

**A) –al**

Adjectives ending -al are usually formed from nouns, and often mean 'relating to the noun', e.g. a musical instrument (from music), a political issue (from politics), an electrical fault (related to electricity), a personal opinion (the opinion of one person).

**B) -able**

This suffix forms adjectives from nouns and verbs, and the prefix un- often forms the opposite:

- an enjoyable party
- a comfortable chair (opposite: uncomfortable)
- a suitable word or phrase [right/correct for a particular situation; opposite: unsuitable]
- a reliable service; reliable information [able to be trusted or believed; opposite: unreliable]
- fashionable clothes [popular now with many people; opposite: unfashionable]
- a reasonable decision or price [fair; not a bad decision or price; opposite: unreasonable]
- a sociable person [enjoys being with people; opposite: unsociable]
- a forgettable experience; opposite an unforgettable experience [something that cannot be forgotten]
- a believable story; opposite: an unbelievable story [something that is very surprising and very difficult to believe]

***-ful and -less***

The suffix *-ful* often means 'full of.

e.g. A colourful room has a lot of colour in it.

A helpful person gives a lot of help.

A peaceful place is calm and quiet.

**The opposite meaning is sometimes formed by adding the suffix -less to the noun.**

e.g. a useful machine [having a lot of uses]; opposite: a useless machine]

a painful injection [giving pain and being unpleasant; opposite: a painless injection]

a careful driver [drives with care and attention; opposite: a careless driver]

# Lesson 13

**Activity 6.20: Match the words on the left with the words on the right.**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. a national **d** | a. injection |
| 2. a useful_____ | b. mistake |
| 3. a painful_____ | c. price |
| 4. fashionable_____ | d. holiday |
| 5. a careless_____ | e. man |
| 6. an electrical_____ | f. bit of advice |
| 7. an unsociable_____ | g. clothes |
| 8. a reasonable_____ | h. fault |

**Activity 6.21: Complete the sentences by adding suffixes to the following words.**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Careful | useless | unbelievable |
| Helpful | unforgettable | painful |
| Suitable | traditional | |
| Annual | personal | |
| Reasonable | reliable | |

E.g. You must be very ***careful*** when you drive in wet weather.

1) She told us an _____ story about a dog that could speak.
2) The tourist information office was very _____, and told us everything we needed to know.
3) The festival is an _____ event, held on the first Monday in September.
4) It was very _____ when I hit my leg against the corner of that table.
5) This bag is _____; it's too small for me to put anything in it.
6) We've never had any problems with our TV in ten years; it's been very _____.
7) Most people agreed with it, so I think it was a _____ decision.
8) This is just my _____ opinion; others may not agree.
9) Travelling round Hawassa and Arba Minch was an _____ experience.
10) Children perform _____ dances at the ceremony, as they have done for hundreds of years.
11) Do you think this dress is _____ for a wedding?

# SECTION FOUR: Grammar

## Lesson 14

Relative Clauses

I met a girl. She **can speak six languages.**

[Two sentences]

She ⟶ who

I met a girl **who can speak six languages.**

[One sentence]

Kedir is reading a book. The book is about physics.

[Two sentences]

The book ⟶ which/that

Kedir is reading a book **which is about physics**.

or

Kedir is reading a book **that is about physics.**

[One sentence]

**Activity 6.22: Based on the context presented above, answer the following questions.**

a. What is the function of the underlined parts?

b. Write the name of your friend. Write also her/his one characteristic. Then, put the information together as follows.

_____ (name of your friend) who _____ (a characteristic) is my friend.

**Study this example situation.**

Last week, we had a party, and a lot of people came. Everybody enjoyed it.

Everybody who came to the party enjoyed it.

What is the function of the clause 'who came to the party'

- **A relative clause tells us which person or thing (or what kind of person or thing) the speaker or the writer means.**

e.g. The woman who lives next door to me ('who lives next door to me' tells us which woman

√ *Who* is used for people (not things)

e.g. The student **who is sitting beside me** is very friendly.

√ *That* is for things or people.

e.g. An airplane is a machine **that flies.**

The people **that work in this school** are kind.

√ *Which* is for things (not for people)

e.g. An airplane is a machine **which flies**.

√ *Whose* is to refer to the person or thing something belongs to.

Hawi, **whose daughter stood first,** is a policewoman.

**Activity 6.23: What differences do you see between the two sentences?**

a. My father, **who is 50 years old**, is a businessman.

b. People **who commit crimes** should be arrested.

Discuss your answers with your partner.

**Defining relative clauses**

1) The house **that we were thinking of buying** has been sold.

2) The girl **who was hit** by the bike wasn't seriously hurt.

3) The award was given to Hana, **whose scores were impressive**.

Sentences 1, 2, and 3 are **defining** relative clauses (also called **restrictive** relative clauses).

- These relative clauses give the information that directly identifies what is being talked about.
- Without the relative clause, we don't know what was being talked about.

**Non-defining relative clauses**

1) *Chechebsa*, *which is my favourie food*, is expensive.
2) My aunt gave me her number, which I wrote on a piece of paper.
3) Abera's father, who is 78, runs five kilometres every day.
4) The Prime Minister, whose speech is impressive, has gone to Kenya.

Sentences 1, 2, 3, and 4 are **non-defining** relative clauses (also called **non-restrictive** relative clauses).

- Non-defining relative clauses give us extra information about someone or something. It is not essential for understanding who or what we are talking about.
- We always use a relative pronoun to start a non-defining relative clause: ***who, which, whose, when*** or ***where*** (but not ***that***). We also use commas to separate the clause from the rest of the sentence.

**Places and times**

We can use ***which*** with a preposition to talk about places and times.

*Examples:*

a. *Sheger Park, **which** is found in Addis Ababa, is a beautiful place.*
   *Sheger Park, **where** my parents celebrated their birthday, is an attractive place..*

b. *September, **which** Ethiopian New Year is celebrated in, is a bright month.*
   *September, **when** Ethiopian New Year is celebrated, is a bright month.*

# Lesson 15

**Activity 6.24: Make one sentence from two sentences. See the example below.**

Example: A man phoned. He didn't give his name.

• The man ***who phoned*** didn't give his name.

1. A woman opened the door. She was wearing a yellow dress.

• The woman _____ a yellow dress.

2. Some students took the exam. Most of them passed.

• Most of the students_____

3. The policeman stopped our car. He wasn't very friendly.

• The policeman _____

**Activity 6.25: Fill in the blank spaces with either *who* or *which*.**

e.g. I met a woman who can speak six languages.

1. What's the name of the man _____ has just started work in your office?
2. What's the name of the river _____ flows through the town?
3. Where is the picture _____was hanging on the wall?
4. Do you know anybody_____ wants to buy a car?
5. You always ask questions _____ are difficult to answer.
6. I have a friend _____is very good at repairing cars.

**Activity 6.26: Complete the sentences according to the information given in brackets.**

Example: My brother is an architect. (He lives in Mekelle.)

My brother, ***who lives in Mekelle***, is an architect.

1. The strike at the factory has now ended. (The strike began ten days ago.)

The strike at the factory _____.

2. I was looking for a book this morning. (I've found it now.)

I've found _____.

3. I've had my car for 15 years. (This car has never broken down.)

My car _____.

4. A lot of people applied for the job. (Few of them had the necessary qualifications.)

Few of _____.

5. Haimanot showed me a picture of her brother. (Her brother is a police officer.) Haimanot showed me _____.

# SECTION FIVE: Writing

## Lesson 16

### Summarizing a text

**Activity 6.27: Read the following text. Write a brief summary of the text in one or two sentences.**

► **Do not attempt to copy directly from the text. Use your own words and expressions.**

The Amazon forest covers five million square kilometers, an area as big as the whole Europe excluding Russia. It contains one third of the world's trees. However, the trees are disappearing. By 1974, a quarter of the forest had already been cut down. In the following year, 1975, four per cent of the remaining trees disappeared. If the destruction of the forest continues at the same rate, there will be nothing left in a few years.

What will happen if more of the Amazon forest is cut down? According to climatologists if the Amazon forest disappears, there will be less oxygen and it will be difficult for us to breathe. The temperature will rise. The ice-caps at the North and the South poles will melt. Even the sea level will rise. Therefore, seaside cities will be flooded.

All scientists agree that if we destroy the Amazon forest, it will be an environmental suicide. Life on earth will become difficult.